

Indian Statistical Institute, Bangalore
B. Math I, First Semester, 2025-26
Back Paper Examination
Probability Theory I
Maximum Score 75

23.12.25

Duration: 2.5 Hours

Calculators and two pages (one sided) of notes allowed.
Each question is worth 15 points.

1. (7+8) An ordinary deck of 52 cards is divided into 4 equal parts randomly, that is, each division is equally likely. What is the probability that each pile contains one Queen?
 - (a) Count the number of ways to divide a deck into four equal parts. Count the number of such divisions in which there is exactly one queen in each part. Use these to find the required probability.
 - (b) Find the probability of having exactly one Queen in a randomly chosen set of 13 cards out of the deck. Find the conditional probability of having exactly one Queen in a randomly chosen set of 13 cards out of the remaining 39. Continue this argument to find the required probability.
2. (3+4+8) Two dice are rolled together.
 - (a) Find the probability that the sum of the rolls is five.
 - (b) Find the probability that the sum is even.
 - (c) The experiment of rolling two dice together is repeated multiple times. What is the probability that a sum of five appears twice before an even sum is observed eight times?
3. (10) Suppose that X is a normally distributed random variable with mean μ and variance σ^2 . If $P(X < 10) = .67$ and $P(X < 20) = .975$, find the values of μ and σ^2 (The best approximation possible using the normal table provided).
4. (10) Let $X \sim Unif[-1, 2]$. Find the probability density function of the random variable $Y = X^4$.
5. (8+7) Suppose X and Y are two independent random variables, each distributed as Geometric(0.3).
 - (a) Find $P(X > Y)$ and hence find $P(X = Y)$
 - (b) Find $P(X \geq 2Y \mid X > Y)$.
6. (3+3+4) The joint probability mass function of X and Y is given by
$$p(1, 1) = .9, \quad p(1, 2) = .04, \quad p(2, 1) = .03, \quad p(2, 2) = .03$$
 - (a) Find the marginal distribution of X .
 - (b) Find the conditional distribution of X given $Y = 1$
 - (c) Find the distribution of $X - Y$

Table 5.1 Area $\Phi(x)$ Under the Standard Normal Curve to the Left of X .

[illegible]